

Enterprise Risk Management Institute [ERMI] Professor Peter Wyer Documentation Underpinning Application for Accreditation as 'CPD Approved Provider'

This application documentation is structured in 2 sections as follows:

Section 1: Summary Strategic Training and Development Frame – the Context for Quality Assurance

[Enterprise Risk Management Strategic Training and Development Frame 2023-2028]

- o Overview of Current Training and Business Support Provision
- o Mission
- o Vision
- o Management and Staffing
- o Operations

Section 2: Quality Assurance

Quality Assurance Framework

- o Our approach to quality assurance
- o Our guiding principles supporting realisation of vision and direction
- o Applying the principles

Quality Manual [Our Policies articulating the Quality Assurance Framework]

- o Programme, Development, Review and Approval Policy
- o Assessment and Internal Verification Policy
- o Appeals Policy and Procedure
- o Safeguarding Policy
- o Malpractice Policy
- o Reflective Practice Record
- o Programme Evaluation and Review (policy; guidance; forms)
- o Cookies Policy
- o Equal Opportunities Learners Charter
- o Reasonable Adjustments and Special Circumstances Policy
- o Data Protection Act Policy
- o Health and Safety Policy
- o Privacy Policy

Section 1: Enterprise Risk Management Institute [ERMI] Strategic Training and Development Frame - the Context for Quality Assurance of Training and Business Support Provision

1. Overview of ERMI Training and Business Support Provision

The Company:

Enterprise Risk Management Institute t/a ERM Africa, founded in 2009, is a leading professional risk management training, advisory and consulting firm located in Accra. It is registered under the laws of the Republic of Ghana: registration number-COOO4977165. ERM Africa is accredited by the London Accreditation Certification Board (LACB), United Kingdom and Association of Certified Anti Money Laundering Specialists (ACAMS), USA. ERM Africa consults for private and public institutions across Africa, Europe and United Kingdom. And offers high quality training provision for individuals and organisations locally and worldwide.

Located in the University of Ghana, Legon, ERMI is evolving as a leading professional risk management training, advisory and consulting organisation. ERM Africa is the accredited training partner and Examination centre for LAPT and ACAMS.

Programmes and Consultancy

ERMI adopts an applied, practical and vocational orientation – informed by state-of-the-art business and academic understanding. Thus, support provision which is practically relevant and academically rigorous. Thereby equipping the participant client-base for effective engagement and innovative contribution in the ‘world of specialists’ whilst promoting personal professional progression and business growth.

ERMI offers development opportunity for individuals at all career levels across all industry sectors n through the pursuance of a wide variety of courses and support provision, including:

Certificate:

- Certified Information Systems Auditor
- Certified Risk Management Specialist
- Certified Internal Auditor
- Certified Environmental & Social Risk Management Specialist
- Certified Agribusiness Specialist
- Certified Financial Crime Investigation & Anti Money Laundering Specialist
- Certified Public Private Partnership Specialist

Advanced:

- Financial Crime Investigation and Anti-Money Laundering
- Enterprise Risk Management
- Information & Cybersecurity
- Public Private Partnership
- Environmental and Social Risk Management
- Agribusiness

- Business Development and Entrepreneurship Management

Postgraduate Certificate:

- Financial Crime Investigation and Anti-Money Laundering
- Enterprise Risk Management
- Public Private Partnership
- Environmental and Social Risk Management
- Forensic and Cybersecurity Risk Management
- Business Development and Entrepreneurship Management

Postgraduate Diploma:

- Anti-Money Laundering and Financial Crime
- Advanced Enterprise Risk Management
- Forensic and Cybersecurity Risk Management
- Public Private Partnership

2. The ERM Institute Mission and Vision

[a] ERM Institute Mission Statement

Our company mission is:

To create, design and deliver innovative products and services that enable growth-seeking micro, small and medium sized organisations and career-pursuing individuals to prosper in their uncertain operating environments. We strive to help our clients foster an ever-increasing business resiliency, enterprise continuity and sustainable growth through innovative modes of strategic development, resilience and risk-management training and consultancy support - which facilitate ongoing build-up of capability to identify, learn about and creatively act upon unfolding challenges in both external and internal business contexts. This through:

- Ongoing research into, and 'partnership working' with, growth-oriented and growth-achieving micro and small enterprises and medium size businesses to progressively build understanding of, disseminate and implement into future business practice state-of-the-art strategic management, business resilience and risk management knowledge, skills and abilities
- Development and application of innovative learning and delivery approaches and vehicles that creatively embrace state-of-the-art content - but also facilitate the nurture of individual and organisational 'resilient learning capability'
- Provision of high-quality customised and client-specific support training and consultancy

[b] ERM Institute Vision

ERM Institute will be:

- A leading accredited provider of high-quality ERM, strategic development and business resilience training, consultancy and advisory support for individuals and for organisations of all sizes and forms - in Ghana, within the wider African continent and internationally

- Responsive to the ever-changing business environment and a resolute inquisitor of what constitutes 'best enterprise risk management, strategic management and business resilience practices'
- At the cutting edge of growth-enhancing application of identified 'best management practices' in terms of design of creative modes of support provision and delivery approaches commensurate with the needs of our varied clientele
- At the forefront of understanding and responding to the distinctiveness of micro enterprises and small businesses vis-à-vis large well-resourced companies and thus cognizant of their differing characteristics, size related problem-types and related support needs
- A 'business resilience' world-lead in the address of confusion and absence of unity on just what 'small business resilience' should and could involve – culminating as lead support practitioner in the fostering of 'holistic micro and small business resilience capability'
- Recognised as 'first port of call' by, and 'close working partner' for ERM, strategic development and business resilience support-seeking customer bases across all sectors and within different geographic locations and at differing stages of enterprise development

To attain this vision involves us distinguishing ourselves in:

- Constantly pushing our own research and insight-building capabilities [our formal and informal self-learning activities and abilities] in terms of ongoing understanding-build of the changing external business environment and the 'best management practices' adopted by successful growth-achieving enterprises in dealing with such unfolding change contexts
- Building depth of understanding of individual 'learning process' as key frame of reference in our approach to design and development of training and consultancy support provision and programmes – particularly with regard to how small business owner managers most effectively learn, and thus how entrepreneurial learning differs from other forms of learning
- Simultaneously working cooperatively, collaboratively and competitively with other lead business support providers [in academia and private sector support] to keep abreast of the nature and form of best practice design and delivery business support models – including most effective new technologies and learning contexts
- Creatively adopting holistic and multi-disciplinary approaches to business support provision – progressively developing our own capability to foster micro enterprise and small business management abilities and behaviours in our client enterprises through vantage point of a number of complementary 'guiding lenses' [rather than through any one single academic or management discipline lens]. Thus, for example, combination 'best small business strategic management' lens; finance lens; HRM lens; entrepreneurial learning lens; risk management lens; business resilience lens
- Fully receptive to the nature of the business support needs of actual and potential client bases, including recognition of their preferred learning styles and learning contexts and of constraints and limitations which may impact on their ability and/or willingness to access external support provision – and thus the imperative of our offering high-level flexibility in meeting the support needs of clientele both in terms of the forms of support provision, delivery modes and location of that provision.

3. ERM Institute Management, Staffing and Operations

[a] Leadership and Core Delivery Expertise: ERMI has a 5-member board of directors who oversee the strategic direction of the company and a Chief Executive Officer with 6 key management persons who run the day- to-day Operations of ERMI. The operational staff includes salespersons, drivers, facilitators and temporary staff.

[b] Delivery: ERM Africa offers flexibility in delivery modes to meet the needs of local, regional and international clientele – providing breadth of client choice.

Methods employed include: Lectures, Discussions, Role Play and Case Studies either through face-to-face interactions or online platforms. The sessions are designed to be interactive and experiential.

[c] The Underpinning ERMI Delivery Technologies: ERMI utilises state-of-the-art teaching and learning technologies, both in face-to-face classroom and online learning contexts

Section 2 below presents the ERMI approach to Quality Assurance

Section 2: Quality Assurance Framework - A Quality and Standards Framework for Enterprise Risk Management Institute [ERMI] Training and Business Development Support Provision

This section of the 'CPD Approved Provider Status' application presents the Enterprise Risk Management Institute 'Quality Assurance Framework' designed to ensure that ERMI delivers on the vision for training and business support laid out in the ERMI Strategic Training and Development Frame 2023-2028 [presented as context of this application in the opening 'section one' above] and meets the expectations laid out within industry benchmark standards and requirements of ERMI external partners.

1. Scope

This Quality Assurance Framework sets out ERMI's approach to assuring standards with regard to risk management, business resilience and strategic development training, education and enterprise support provision; and to enhancing the quality of provision leading to a certificated *course completion award*, certificate or diploma programme-awards and/or CPD credits [either from ERMI or from its associate awarding bodies]. It identifies the principles by which the overarching Framework is managed and developed. Anyone applying, managing or developing elements of the Framework should do so with reference to the approach and principles laid out herein.

Date approved: September 5th 2023 [by Dr Peter Wyer]. Date for review: Annual Review by ERMI CEO and Advisory Board due September 2024. To be read in conjunction with: Individual Quality Policies within the ERMI 'Quality Manual' - which is included as the concluding sub-section below.

2. Quality Assurance Framework

The Quality Assurance Framework underpins ERMI commitment to risk management training and business support excellence. The framework is developed to support the continual improvement of our training and support provision with regard to excellence of individual client 'learner' experience and effecting of productive contribution to the client learner personal professional development and organisational development performance of the client organisation. The framework *is designed to ensure that ERMI delivers on the vision for its training and business support provision* laid out in the ERMI Strategic Training and Development Frame 2023-2028 [in section one above] and meets the expectations laid out within industry benchmark standards and requirements of external and approval bodies with whom it partners. The Quality Assurance Framework [Quality and Standards Framework] applies to all training, taught and consultancy support programmes, provided through ERMI, its partnerships and approved or validated provision. It covers:

- o All provision leading to certification from the company
- o All provision leading to an award or award of credit by the company's external approving or accrediting partnership bodies

The Quality Manual which forms the final part of this documentation and embraces all policies is the means by which the Framework is articulated. This section 2 in its totality lays out our approach to the management of quality, standards and enhancement and the principles by which the Framework will continue to be developed.

[a] Our Approach

At the core of the Framework is a systematic approach to standards and quality of training, business support and education provision. The approach requires:

- o The clear articulation of training, education and business support standards and the provision of an environment which enables ERMI programme learners to meet those standards

- o Robust quality assurance mechanisms which evidence how we support our learners in meeting the standards we have set and subsequently judge their achievement in the context of those standards
- o A focus on training, business support and education quality through regular analysis of how well we deliver on our commitment to the provision of high-quality individual learning experience, business education and organisational development
- o A commitment to quality enhancement embedded within every aspect of our provision

[b] Our Principles

The principles embedded in our Quality and Standards Framework support the realisation of ERMI's vision for its future development of its training, professional and organisational development support provision, providing reference point for all staff. Thus:

Principle1: A Consistent Embrace of Core Values

We have explicit core values based upon a desire for:

- Integrity, honesty and total respect for each other, and as underpinning to all our working relationships and interfaces with our stakeholders and the wider communities within which we operate
- Creation of a safe and convivial work and learning environment which embraces and fosters a culture of well-being and climate for personal enhancement of staff and client-learners
- Robust understanding of, and timely responsiveness to, client needs
- High levels of proactivity and inquisitiveness in the identification, dissemination and implementation of 'best world of management practices' and modes of learning facilitation – as underpinnings to fostering sustained client development and growth and of our staff; and in the nurturing of EMRI toward lead-organisation and influencer status in our fields of operation.

Our Quality Framework puts in place a set of complementary policies which facilitate and encourage both internal core staff and external freelance supporting providers adherence to these core values.

Principle 2: Exceptional Client Service

We position our clients at the forefront of all we do. Not only do we constantly strive to understand and respond to their self-identified individual needs, we recognise that many potential clients require assistance in fully understanding the nature and form of their support needs. Thus, we provide a bridge between the present state of client operation and what currently constitutes 'best business practice' – introducing clients to best practice and facilitating their uptake of that best practice.

Crucially, we design and deliver support provision which embraces not only state -of-the-art programme content, but also focus upon 'learning process'. Integral to our client service is thus the fostering of effective and resilient learners. Thereby not only building state of the art 'best practice' understanding and capability, but also the nurture of 'ever-more effective and resilient learner' as key source of client future competitive advantage in learning about and acting upon the highly uncertain environments in which they strive to survive and grow.

Importantly, integral to our delivery of exceptional client service is our 'listening propensity' and constant receptiveness to the perspectives and views of our clients and potential clients with regard to all aspects of our support provision. And thus, our striving for ongoing enhancement of all dimensions of the learner experience. The Quality Framework supports a variety of formal and

informal mechanisms for seeking perspectives of and feedback from our client learners [such as formal and informal interaction with learners throughout particular learning and development programmes and learning episodes]. And programme review and development procedures which incorporate feedback and suggestions from learners and potential learners and incorporate perspectives from industry experts, members of our advisory board and other stakeholders.

Principle 3: Practically Relevant and Academically Rigorous Support Provision:

All dimensions of our support provision strive to be practically-relevant for our client-bases - be they organisations, their managers or employees or owner manager entrepreneurs. And this practical relevance to a great extent derives from robust academic underpinnings. This with regard to utilisation of current academic research-produced knowledge-bases which inform both programme design to embrace state-of-art 'content' and present-day best teaching and learning practices and technologies which help facilitate our programme delivery. Crucially, we take our lead from academia in the effective assessment of our client-learners progress throughout their programmes – here recognising the glove-tight relationship between teaching, learning and assessment. Innovative example here is our use where appropriate of client-learner partnership working with a 'live small businesses' as integrated learning and assessment vehicle.

The Quality Framework in its embrace of programme review and development procedures facilitates the utilisation of feedback and suggestions from learners, potential learners, business practice experts and research academics to help ensure our programmes maintain practical relevance and are effectively and appropriately academically informed and grounded to manifest in exceptional client service. Not least in a 'best practice- academic underpinnings learning experience' which enables the client to more effectively input to his organisation's growth and development, professionally develop along his or her career path and/or engage in future academic study. Our ERMI employ of lead entrepreneurial academics who bridge academia and the world of business practice reinforces our commitment to this practical relevance- academically underpinned principle.

Principle 4: Sustainable Social Impact Support Provision

We are committed to concertedly helping the development and growth of individuals and organisations – but also the wider communities within which they sit.

We are thus fully committed to ensuring that our programmes help foster 'productive entrepreneurship' – entrepreneurship which contributes to societal well-being as a whole [as opposed to destructive entrepreneurship whereby entrepreneurial activity benefits an individual but at a cost to wider society].

Thus, wherever possible the design and delivery of our programmes will be 'full context' informed. Our aim is to assist our client-learners progress through a carefully designed programme which not only meets their own immediate individual needs but also helps them enhance their own knowledge, behaviours and abilities and simultaneously become more cognisant of how they or they and their organisation can more effectively contribute to the development of their local communities, including through investment in sustainable 'social impact' projects.

The Quality Framework thus embraces policies and procedures which facilitate our ability to constantly build understanding of the local community contexts we serve, and thus the associate ability to sit our working interfaces with our client-bases within that full context. And where appropriate give focus to 'sustainable social impact' context of our programme design, development and delivery.

[c] Our Expectation

The overall quality assurance approach and underpinning Principles require adherence to the policies and procedures that combine to form The Quality and Standards Framework. The following guidance supports the application of the principles.

Applying the Principles: When developing, reviewing and improving our training and business support provision *the reference point principles outlined above* should be practically applied by all staff [ERMI and its outsourced freelance training and support providers] through activities such as:

- o Encouraging all staff to take every opportunity to explore and discover new insights and understanding relating to knowledge content of ERMI area of training and consultancy provision – and to identify potential client-bases who require innovative support provision
- o Thus, as integral part of day-to-day activities, collect and use external and internally sourced information and insight to inform new support provision development and review and enhancement of existing provision
- o Identify and document relevant internal and external benchmark standards, best practice examples and insight from the differing industry and service sectors served by ERMI, and from the training sector; and context-specific insight from those involved in the world of business practice and from professional bodies
- o All staff to immerse themselves in a constant self-education - Identify and draw on relevant professional and academic research and snippets of media-revealed understanding. And disseminate this insight among company colleagues: enable use of relevant academic insight and professional and media reports to inject rigour to our practice-oriented provision
- o Foster collaboration with such as academic institutions and commercial organisations to discover or create innovative developmental opportunities in terms of new training programmes and/or enhanced delivery modes or processes.

The following sub-section presents a summary Quality Manual, the key role of which is to articulate the Quality Assurance Framework:

The Quality Manual Articulating the Quality Assurance Framework

Quality Manual Contents:

1. *Introduction – Quality at ERMI*
2. *Governance Committee and Delegation Structure – Summary*
3. *Evaluation of Quality Assurance Procedures*

The Policies

- *Programme Content Review and Approval Policy*
- *Assessment and Internal Verification Policy*
- *Appeals Policy and Procedure • Malpractice Policy*
- *Reflective Practice Record • Programme Evaluation and Review*
- *Equal Opportunities Learners Charter*
- *Safeguarding Policy*
- *Complaints Policy*
- *Reasonable Adjustments and Special Circumstances Policy*
- *Privacy Policy/Data Protection Policy*
- *Responsible Marketing Procedures*

1. Introduction - Quality at ERMI:

The company's generic policies and its training- and business support-specific policies, procedures and regulations provide the institutional framework through which we manage the standards of our assessed and non-assessed provision and enhance the quality of learning and development opportunities that we offer our programme participants.

This Quality Manual fleshes out and articulates the ERMI Quality Assurance Framework. The Quality Manual contains policies aligned with the company's Regulations supported by accompanying guidance, forms and supplementary information.

Key Definitions: We at ERMI approach quality provision and its ongoing enhancement from within the following definitional frame:

o ***Training and Business Support Standards:*** the threshold of achievement required for a learner to successfully achieve their certification or award

o ***Training and Business Support Quality:*** how well the learning opportunities that are provided support learners to achieve the articulated learning outcomes within our programmes and enhance their professional development

o ***Quality Assurance:*** a range of policies and procedures designed to safeguard training and support provision standards and the quality of learning opportunities

o ***Enhancement:*** taking deliberate action to ensure continual improvement of our programme participants' learning experience

Broad Outline of the Key Components Covered by the Quality Assurance Framework:

o ERMI is committed to establishing policies and procedures for learner and delegate ***Recruitment, Selection and Admission*** that are fair, clear and accurate, and in accordance with our ***Equal Opportunities Strategy***

o The ***Programme Development and Approval Processes*** are designed to ensure the development of programmes that:

- Demonstrate strategic fit with ERMI's overall developmental vision
- Are demand led and financially viable and value-adding to all parties
- Offer learning opportunities for its programme participants that are of high quality
- Align with external industry and academic benchmarking standards
- Are research-informed, academically rigorous but always of practical relevance

o ***Programme Evaluation*** is underpinned by regular mechanisms to review the success of the programmes and to identify areas for enhancement

o Readily available support and information for learners are essential prongs of high-quality training programme provision

o Combination of ***formal and informal feedback mechanisms and procedures*** ensure that learner views and suggestions are key input to ***Programme Evaluation and Review***

o The company's ***Malpractices and Assessments Policies*** in their embrace of disciplinary process make explicit our expected values and behaviours of learners and staff

o In the event of an instance of delegate dissatisfaction or concern over their learning experience, the ERMI ***learner complaints procedures*** facilitate rectification of such situations

- o Our **Assessment and Feedback Policy** guides rigorous and fair assessment and provision of timely feedback.
- o And our **Appeals Policy** enables learners to challenge outcomes of the programmes we deliver that involve formal assessments.
- o Committed to facilitating excellence of learning experience and personal development of all learners, our **Reasonable Adjustments and Special Considerations Policy** addresses the issue of ensuring equal opportunity in the study, learning and assessment processes, giving necessary attention to any forms of disability or difficulty that places a learner at substantial disadvantage in their learning or assessment processes
- o Our approach to information we collect from users of our website and our training and consultancy services is embraced in our **Privacy Policy/Data Protection Policy** - making explicit how in collecting this information, we are acting as a data controller and, by law, we are required to provide individual users with information about us, about why and how we use their data, and about the rights they have over their data

2. Governance Committee and Delegation Structure

Decision-making authority and lead decision-maker responsibilities are at present shared by our directors. A Committee Structure will be progressively moulded to facilitate future ongoing development of ERMI training and business support provision. Overriding decision-making authority regarding programme design, development, delivery and review currently sits with the CEO/lead directors.

3. Evaluation of Quality Assurance Procedures

The ERMI lead directors will arrange quarterly Quality Assurance meetings to oversee progress and effectiveness of approach to quality provision. The meetings will be used to ensure effective communication with all internal staff and outsourced trainers involved in programme design, development and delivery, and will address issues such as interface with programme candidates and prospective candidates, review of learning resources, appropriateness of delivery and assessment modes and effectiveness of quality assurance procedures. The sharing of perspectives and of good practice will be central to and underpin the meetings.

4. The Policies and Procedures

The ERM Institute policies forming the core of this Quality Manual are listed below: *[the full policies are contained in separate Word document files]:*

- o Programme Content Review and Approval Policy
- o Assessment and Internal Verification Policy
- o Appeals Policy and Procedure
- o Safeguarding Policy
- o Malpractice Policy
- o Reflective Practice Record
- o Programme Evaluation and Review
- o Equal Opportunities Learners Charter
- o Complaints Policy

- Reasonable Adjustments and Special Circumstances Policy
- Privacy Policy/Data Protection Act Policy
- Responsible Marketing Procedures